

InstaCalc */evolve*

20 skeletons, rated — and the one to build

Twenty homepage + calc-navigation concepts, each borrowing the skeleton of an app people already know, all wearing today's InstaCalc theme so you compare structure, not skin. New in v3: a fidelity pass (syntax-highlighted live editor, computed results emphasized over inputs, real hover/focus states), an honest score for every layout, and **The Studio** — the recommended browse + create synthesis, now the default view at */evolve*.

The Studio combines what scored: the full notebook editor as the landing page itself — zero clicks to calculating, and the multi-line, named-variable, shareable calc (the actual differentiator) visible from the first second — plus Notion's workspace rail, YouTube's up-next, a McMaster-dense gallery under the editor, and Linear's ⌘K. Create and browse share one screen without fighting. (v3.1: One Box demoted from 9.0 to 4.0 — a giant single input is Google's turf and hides what makes InstaCalc different.)

Every calc in these screenshots is a real, live evaluator. Flip layouts with ← →, G for the grid, T for light theme.

The verdict

what each skeleton is worth to InstaCalc — and what to steal from it

#	LAYOUT	INSPIRED BY	SCORE	WHY IT WORKS	WHY IT DOESN'T
01	The Workspace	Notion	8.5	Best create/organize model: rail + pages + linked gallery database.	Browse is a second-class citizen.
02	The Channel Grid	YouTube	8.0	Player + up-next is the best open-calc pattern; browsing never ends.	Chrome-heavy for a small tool.
03	The Catalog	McMaster-Carr	8.0	Best power browse: dense specs, filters, instant scan.	Cold for newcomers; create absent.
04	The Command Line	Linear	7.5	⌘K and the peek panel are pure keepers.	Whole frame intimidates casual users.
05	The Feed	Reddit	7.0	Remix counts + votes = the social loop InstaCalc deserves.	Feed buries the editor.
06	The Marketplace	Airbnb	7.0	Friendliest card language and category chips.	Shopping metaphor stops at browsing.
07	The Shelves	Spotify	6.5	Collections and a “continue where you left off” shelf.	Now-playing bar is a gimmick here.
08	The Grid	Excel	6.5	Instant familiarity for spreadsheet refugees; great import/alt view.	Ceiling on delight; browse an afterthought.
09	The Repo	GitHub	6.5	Remix/version/attribution semantics are exactly right.	Too much chrome for 8 lines of math.
10	The Canvas	Figma	6.0	Properties panel for result formatting is a good idea.	Infinite canvas doesn't pay rent.
11	The Pitch	Stripe	6.0	Strong logged-out marketing page with a live demo.	It's a brochure, not the product.
12	The Wall	Pinterest	5.5	Big-answer pins → great share images for social.	Browse-only; no path to create.
13	The Keynote	Apple	5.5	Beautiful poster; sells the feeling.	Low information, low utility.
14	The Ranking	Hacker News	5.0	Perfect as a /trending subpage.	Too thin to be the whole product.
15	The Clubhouse	Slack	5.0	Live calc unfurls in conversation — gold for embeds.	Chat isn't a home for tools.
16	The Reference	Wikipedia	5.0	The infobox IS the embeddable calc widget.	Article frame is the wrong product.
17	The Superstore	Amazon	4.5	Trust signals (uses, ratings) worth stealing.	Commerce metaphor fights “free + instant”.
18	The Directory	Craigslist	4.5	Honest, fast, scannable.	It's a sitemap, not an experience.
19	One Box	Google	4.0	One keeper: zero clicks between landing and calculating.	Google already owns instant answers — and one line hides the multi-line notebook that IS the product. Wrong mental model at the front door.
20	The Stream	TikTok	4.0	Most delightful demo of “math as content”.	Navigation dead-end; impractical.

Scores = fit as InstaCalc's *primary* shell (browse + create + share). Low scorers still contribute: HN → /trending, Wikipedia's infobox → embeddable widget, Slack → live link unfurls, Pinterest → share images, Stripe → the logged-out homepage. **The Studio (next page) is the synthesis of everything ≥7.5.**

The five tests — what makes the layout decision easy and the four sample layouts that all pass them (pages 02–05)

The decision feels hard when five verbs — creating, mode switching, browsing mine, discovery, the feature tour — are treated as five nouns that each demand screen territory. It becomes easy when these five statements are true, and all five are choices:

1. **There is exactly one noun.** A calc — a doc of live lines. “My calcs”, “the gallery”, even “the tour” are just lists of the same object, differing only by whose it is.
2. **Modes aren't places.** Notebook / Sheet / Form / Widget are lenses in the doc header — an attribute of the calc, like bold. Zero navigation budget.
3. **Jobs take turns.** They're a lifecycle, not a dashboard. Each job owns a moment and a *doorway* (⌘K, a rail, a tab, a shelf) — never a territory.
4. **One resident, everyone else visits.** When in doubt, the editor wins. Rank the constituencies once and every future dispute resolves mechanically.
5. **The tour is content.** The seeded first calc — with comments that teach — is the whole onboarding. It costs zero pixels, forever.

The one-sentence layout that falls out: “**InstaCalc is a notebook with a library around it.**” The four samples that follow all pass the tests and differ only in where the library's doorway sits — proof that once the tests hold, the arrangement is a taste call, not an argument:

The Page — library below the fold · **The Desk** — visible but deliberately quiet periphery · **The Drawer** — today's editor untouched, library summoned by one key · **The Deck** — mine as tabs, the library is just another tab.

Feature test for anything new that wants screen space: is it *the object*, *a lens on it*, *a doorway to it*, or *content inside it*? If none — it probably shouldn't exist. If one — its placement is already decided.

The lineup

same product, twenty skeletons — press G on /evolve for this view

- 01

The Studio · the best of all 20

★ Recommended combo — the full notebook editor IS the landing page (zero clicks to calculating), with Notion's workspace rail, YouTube's up-next, a McMaster-dense gallery below, Linear's ⌘K. Create and browse never fight for the screen.
- 02

The Page · the five tests

Easiest possible sentence: “a document editor with a library below it.” One centered column, doorways in the chrome (⌘K, icon rail), library below the fold, and the seeded calc IS the feature tour.
- 03

The Desk · the five tests

Ambient awareness without competition: mine on the left, everyone's on the right — both deliberately dimmer and smaller than the stage. The periphery whispers; only the editor speaks at full volume.
- 04

The Drawer · the five tests

The most conservative easy answer: today's full-bleed editor, untouched. The entire library — mine and everyone's — lives in a drawer summoned by one key. Territory on demand; zero cost when closed.
- 05

The Deck · the five tests

“Browsing mine” dissolves into a tab strip — the same gesture as a browser. The Library is just another tab, because a list of calcs is itself a document. One noun all the way down.
- 06

One Box · Google

The cautionary tale: a one-line answer box is Google's turf, and it hides the multi-line notebook that makes InstaCalc different. Kept as a foil — the keeper is “zero clicks to calculating”, not the single box.
- 07

The Feed · Reddit

Gallery becomes a ranked feed: upvotes, remix counts, topic communities (c/finance). Great for discovery, calc opens in place.
- 08

The Reference · Wikipedia

Every calc is a reference article: dense internal links, contents rail, live calc as the “infobox”. Authority through plainness.
- 09

The Catalog · McMaster-Carr

Ruthless density and speed: every calc is a part with specs. Filter rail, instant search, zero decoration. For power users.
- 10

The Marketplace · Airbnb

Calcs as destinations: big friendly search pill, category chips, preview-forward cards with ratings and saves.
- 11

The Directory · Craigslist

Zero design as a feature: the entire gallery on one page as plain links. Fastest possible

- 13

The Superstore · Amazon

Search-dominant with facet filters and heavy trust signals: ratings, usage counts, “used this month”. Calc gets a Buy-Box.
- 14

The Channel Grid · YouTube

Calcs as videos: preview thumbnails with a “6 steps” badge, author channels, chips for topics. Subscriptions = follow calc authors.
- 15

The Shelves · Spotify

Library with horizontal shelves (“Made for you”, “Trending”) and playlists as calc collections. The open calc lives in a persistent now-playing bar.
- 16

The Workspace · Notion

Calcs as pages in a personal workspace: sidebar tree, breadcrumbs, blocks. Gallery is a linked database at the bottom of the page.
- 17

The Command Line · Linear

For heavy users: dense triage list, side peek, and a ⌘K palette as the primary navigation. Everything reachable without the mouse.
- 18

The Repo · GitHub

A calc is a repo: stars, forks (“remixes”), history, README. Naturally social + versioned — remix culture made explicit.
- 19

The Pitch · Stripe

A real marketing homepage: hero with a floating live product demo, social proof, feature triplet. For the logged-out first impression.
- 20

The Grid · Excel

Meets spreadsheet users where they live: ribbon, formula bar, editable cells with row/column headers, sheet tabs as multiple calcs.
- 21

The Canvas · Figma

Calc as an object on an infinite canvas: layers panel lists every line, properties panel controls format/units/decimals. Community tab = gallery.
- 22

The Wall · Pinterest

Pure visual browse: masonry of calc “pins” at mixed sizes — some show working, some just the big answer. Save to boards = collections.
- 23

The Keynote · Apple

Radical focus: huge type, one device frame, generous whitespace. The gallery appears only as a teaser band. Sells the feeling, not the features.
- 24

The Clubhouse · Slack

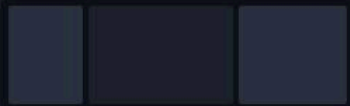
Community-first: topic channels, calcs shared as unfurled live cards inside conversation, reactions as lightweight ratings.

The switcher /evolve opens on this overview — click any card, or arrow-key through layouts

InstaCalc /evolve

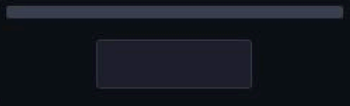
21 homepage + calc-navigation concepts, each borrowing the bones of a familiar app. Same product — live calcs, gallery, search — different skeleton. Use ← → to flip, G for this grid. 
 Evolve today's UI (toggleable) → Workspace user flows → Nav system & view modes →

Close x



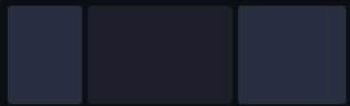
★ RECOMMENDED

1. The Studio · the best of all 20
★ Recommended combo — the full notebook editor IS the landing page (zero clicks to calculating), with Notion's workspace rail, YouTube's up-next, a McMaster-dense gallery below, Linear's ¶K. Create and browse never fight for the screen.
SPLIT STRUCTURE



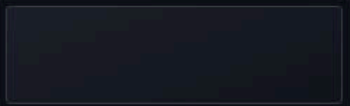
✓ PASSES THE FIVE TESTS

2. The Page · the five tests
Easiest possible sentence: "a document editor with a library below it." One centered column, doorways in the chrome (¶K, icon rail), library below the fold, and the seeded calc IS the feature tour.
CENTER STRUCTURE



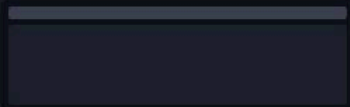
✓ PASSES THE FIVE TESTS

3. The Desk · the five tests
Ambient awareness without competition: mine on the left, everyone's on the right — both deliberately dimmer and smaller than the stage. The periphery whispers; only the editor speaks at full volume.
SPLIT STRUCTURE



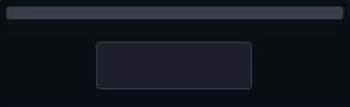
✓ PASSES THE FIVE TESTS

4. The Drawer · the five tests
The most conservative easy answer: today's full-bleed editor, untouched. The entire library — mine and everyone's — lives in a drawer summoned by one key. Territory on demand; zero cost when closed.
CANVAS STRUCTURE

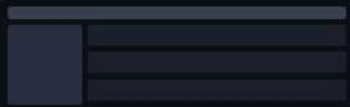


✓ PASSES THE FIVE TESTS

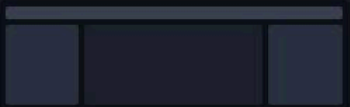
5. The Deck · the five tests
"Browsing mine" dissolves into a tab strip — the same gesture as a browser. The Library is just another tab, because a list of calcs is itself a document. One noun all the way down.
TOPBAR STRUCTURE



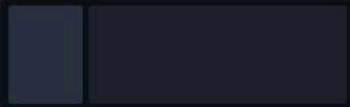
6. One Box · Google
The cautionary tale: a one-line answer box is Google's turf, and it hides the multi-line notebook that makes InstaCalc different. Kept as a foil — the keeper is "zero clicks to calculating", not the single box.
CENTER STRUCTURE



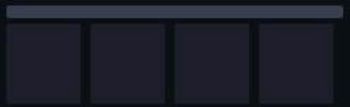
7. The Feed · Reddit
Gallery becomes a ranked feed: upvotes, remix counts, topic communities (c/finance). Great for discovery, calc opens in place.
BOTH STRUCTURE



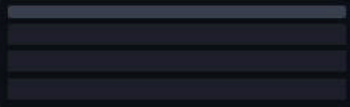
8. The Reference · Wikipedia
Every calc is a reference article: dense internal links, contents rail, live calc as the "infobox". Authority through plainness.
DOC STRUCTURE



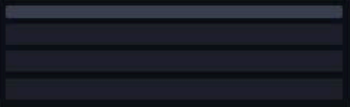
9. The Catalog · McMaster-Carr



10. The Marketplace · Airbnb



11. The Directory · Craigslist



12. The Ranking · Hacker News

InstaCalc

Search 1,642 calcs — or just type math...

⌘K

Remix

New calc

K

WORKSPACE

Home

My calcs12

Shared4

Starred

COLLECTIONS

Events

House hunt

Consulting

+ New collection

GALLERY

Finance412

Health & Fitness187

Home & DIY143

Cooking96

Travel88

Business205

Education117

Browse all 1,642 →

Party Budget

by kazad · autosaved just now · public link

Star 2.4k

Remix 312

Share

Party budget 🎉

guests = 30

30

costPerPerson = 18

18

food = guests * costPerPerson

540

venue = 250

250

music = 120

120

total = food + venue + music

910

perGuest = total / guests

30.33

+ Add a line results update as you type

EVENTS BUDGETING EVERYDAY

Browse the gallery

Trending New Finance For you

loan = 320,000

320,000

rate = 6.2%

0.062

payment / mo

\$1,962

Mortgage Payoff Planner

sarah_m · 24.1k uses

★ 4.8

bill = 86.40

86.40

tip = 20%

17.28

each (4 ppl)

\$25.92

Tip & Bill Splitter

kazad · 18.3k uses

★ 4.9

monthly = 100

100

years = 30

30

future value

\$117,606

Compound Interest Visualizer

mathfan42 · 31.2k uses

★ 4.7

serves = 4 → 11

2.75x

flour = 2 cups

5.5 cups

butter = 6 tbsp

16.5 tbsp

Recipe Scaler

chefdata · 9.8k uses

★ 4.9

miles = 1,240

1,240

mpg = 31

31

fuel cost

\$156

Road Trip Fuel Cost

nomadic · 7.4k uses

★ 4.6

target = 90k/yr

90,000

billable hrs

1,100

rate

\$82/hr

Freelance Hourly Rate

indiehacker · 12.6k uses

★ 4.8

UP NEXT

BMI & Calorie Target

fitcoach · 15.9k uses

Startup Runway

foundr · 8.8k uses

Paint Coverage Estimator

dilyanne · 5.2k uses

Retirement Savings Projector

futureme · 22.4k uses

TRENDING TODAY

1 Mortgage Payoff Planner ▲ 340

2 Tip & Bill Splitter ▲ 288

3 Compound Interest Visualizer ▲ 236

4 Recipe Scaler ▲ 184

5 Road Trip Fuel Cost ▲ 132

Start from a template

Skip the blank page — 1,642 working calcs to remix.

Browse templates

★ Recommended combo — the full notebook editor IS the landing page (zero clicks to calculating), with Notion's workspace rail, YouTube's up-next, a McMaster-dense gallery below, Linear's ⌘K. Create and browse never fight for the screen.

InstaCalc

Search, commands, or math...

+ New calc



**Party Budget**
by kazad · autosaved just now · public link

Notebook Sheet Form Widget Share

```
# Welcome — this notebook is alive 🎉
# change any number and watch →
guests = 30 30
costPerPerson = 18 18
food = guests * costPerPerson 540
# name a value once, reuse it anywhere
venue = 250 250
total = food + venue 790
perGuest = total / guests 26.33
# share = copy the URL. that's it.
```

+ Add a line

Library 1,642 calcs · scroll for more, or press ↵

loan = 320,000 320,000
rate = 6.2% 0.062
payment / mo \$1,962

Mortgage Payoff Planner
sarah_m · 24.1k uses

bill = 86.40 86.40
tip = 20% 17.28
each (4 ppl) \$25.92

Tip & Bill Splitter
kazad · 18.3k uses

monthly = 100 100
years = 30 30
future value \$117,606

Compound Interest Visualizer
mathfan42 · 31.2k uses

serves = 4 → 11 2.75x
flour = 2 cups 5.5 cups
butter = 6 tbsp 16.5 tbsp

Recipe Scaler
chelfdata · 9.8k uses

miles = 1,240 1,240
mpg = 31 31
fuel cost \$156

Road Trip Fuel Cost
nomadic · 7.4k uses

target = 90k/yr 90,000
billable hrs 1,100
rate \$82/hr

Freelance Hourly Rate
indiehackr · 12.6k uses

Easiest possible sentence: “a document editor with a library below it.” One centered column, doorways in the chrome (⌘K, icon rail), library below the fold, and the seeded calc IS the feature tour.

The screenshot displays the InstaCalc web application interface. The main workspace is a dark-themed editor for a calculator titled "Party Budget" by user "kazad". The calculator code is as follows:

```
# Party budget 🎉  
guests = 30  
costPerPerson = 18  
food = guests * costPerPerson  
venue = 250  
music = 120  
total = food + venue + music  
perGuest = total / guests
```

The results of the calculations are displayed on the right side of the code editor:

- 30
- 18
- 540
- 250
- 120
- 910
- 30.33

The interface includes a sidebar on the left with sections for "MY CALCS" (listing "Party Budget", "Mortgage vs Rent", "Japan trip", "Catering remix"), "COLLECTIONS" (listing "Events", "House hunt"), and "LIBRARY" (with a link to "Browse 1,642"). The top navigation bar features a search bar, a "Remix" button, and a "+ New calc" button. The right sidebar contains sections for "WHILE YOU WORK" (listing "Road Trip Fuel Cost", "Freelance Hourly Rate", "BMI & Calorie Target", "Startup Runway", "Paint Coverage Estimator") and "TRENDING" (listing "Mortgage Payoff Planner", "Tip & Bill Splitter", "Compound Interest Visu...").

Ambient awareness without competition: mine on the left, everyone's on the right — both deliberately dimmer and smaller than the stage. The periphery whispers; only the editor speaks at full volume.

The screenshot shows the InstaCalc application interface. On the left is a 'Library' drawer containing a list of calculators, each with a preview of its inputs and outputs. On the right is the main editor area, currently displaying a 'Party Budget' calculator. The interface is dark-themed.

Library (Left Drawer):

- Mortgage Payoff Planner**
Inputs: lo... 320,000, rate... 0.062
User: sarah_m · 24.1k uses · ★ 4.8
- Tip & Bill Splitter**
Inputs: bill... 86.40, tip... 17.28
User: kazad · 18.3k uses · ★ 4.9
- Compound Interest Visualizer**
Inputs: monthl... 100, years... 30
User: mathfan42 · 31.2k uses · ★ 4.7
- Recipe Scaler**
Inputs: serv... 2.75x, f... 5.5 cups
User: chefdata · 9.8k uses · ★ 4.9
- Road Trip Fuel Cost**
Inputs: mile... 1,240, mpg = 31
User: nomadic · 7.4k uses · ★ 4.6
- Freelance Hourly Rate**
Inputs: tar... 90,000, bill... 1,100
User: indiehacker · 12.6k uses · ★ 4.8
- BMI & Calorie Target**
Inputs: weig... 78 kg, hei... 1.78 m
User: fitcoach · 15.9k uses · ★ 4.5

Party Budget Calculator (Right Editor):

by kazad · autosaved just now

Tab: Notebook | Sheet | Form | Widget

```
# Party budget 🍷
guests = 30                                     30
costPerPerson = 18                             18
food = guests * costPerPerson                  540
venue = 250                                    250
music = 120                                    120
total = food + venue + music                    910
perGuest = total / guests                       30.33
```

Footer: L toggles · space peeks · ↵ opens — your editor never moved

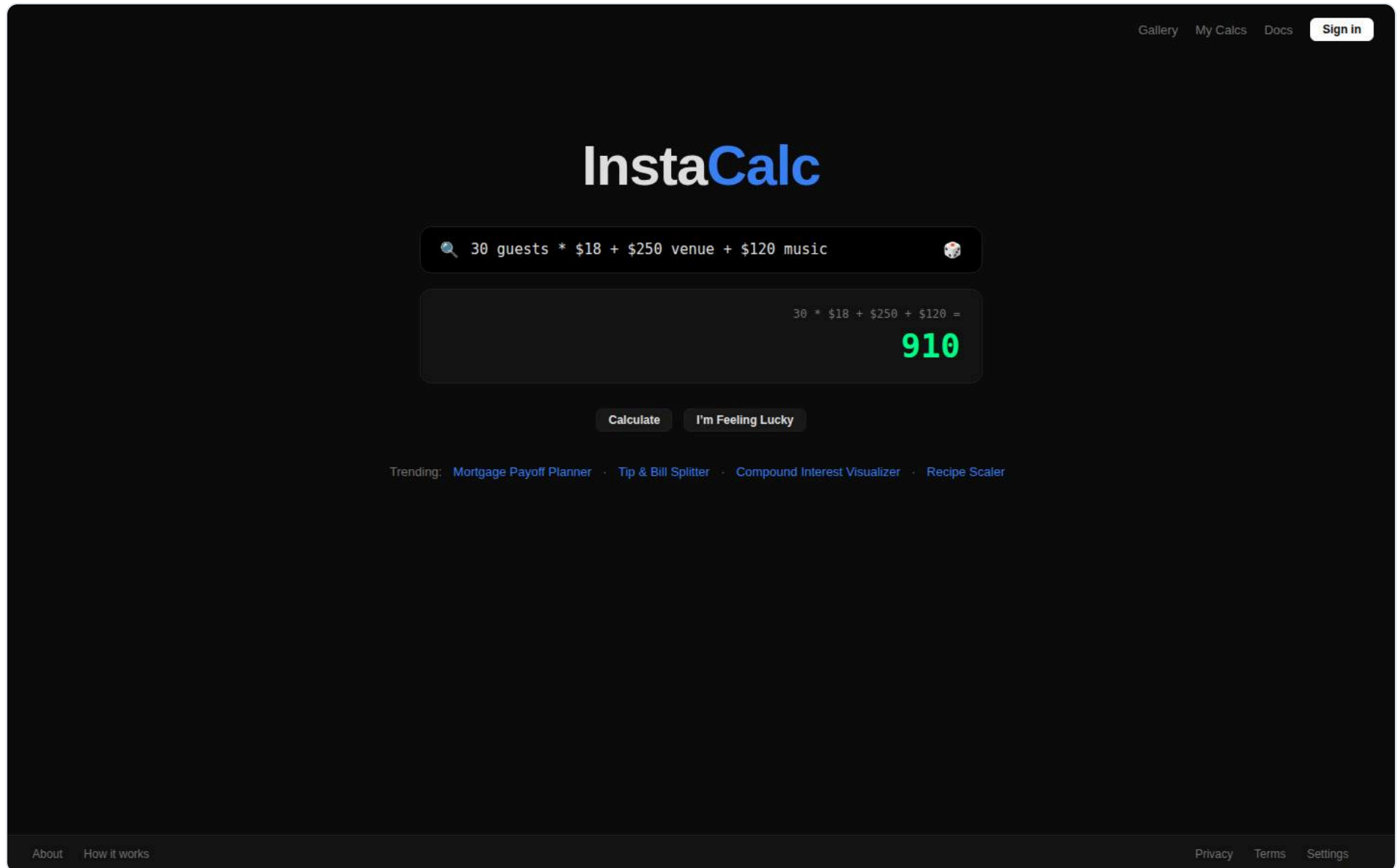
The most conservative easy answer: today's full-bleed editor, untouched. The entire library — mine and everyone's — lives in a drawer summoned by one key. Territory on demand; zero cost when closed.

The screenshot shows the InstaCalc application interface. At the top, there's a search bar with the text "Search, commands, or math..." and a "Remix" button. Below the search bar, there's a tab strip with three tabs: "Party Budget", "Mortgage vs Rent", and "Japan trip". The "Party Budget" tab is active. The main content area shows a calculation for a party budget. The calculation is as follows:

# Party budget	
guests = 30	30
costPerPerson = 18	18
food = guests * costPerPerson	540
venue = 250	250
music = 120	120
total = food + venue + music	910
perGuest = total / guests	30.33

At the bottom of the interface, there's a footer with keyboard shortcuts: "1-9 switch tabs", "T new calc", and "K anything else". To the right of the shortcuts, there's a note: "the Library tab is just another document — a list of calcs".

“Browsing mine” dissolves into a tab strip — the same gesture as a browser. The Library is just another tab, because a list of calcs is itself a document. One noun all the way down.



The cautionary tale: a one-line answer box is Google's turf, and it hides the multi-line notebook that makes InstaCalc different. Kept as a foil — the keeper is “zero clicks to calculating”, not the single box.

InstaCalc

Search calculators, topics, people...

Browse Gallery

+ Create Calc

FEEDS

Home

Popular

All

TOPICS

c/finance

c/health

c/home

c/cooking

c/travel

c/business

c/education

c/conversions

c/fun

Your draft · autosaved · share when ready

Party Budget

Party budget

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerPerson540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + music910

perGuest = total / guests30.33

About InstaCalc

The calculator that shows its work. Build a calc in seconds, share it like a link, remix anyone's math.

Create Calc

Browse Gallery

Trending today

BMI & Calorie Target

Startup Runway

Paint Coverage Estimator

Retirement Savings Projector

3,400

c/finance · Posted by u/sarah_m 2d ago

Mortgage Payoff Planner

loan = 320,000320,000

rate = 6.2%0.062

payment / mo\$1,962

84 comments remix (311) share save

2,988

c/fun · Posted by u/kazad 5h ago

Tip & Bill Splitter

bill = 86.4086.40

tip = 20%17.28

each (4 ppl)\$25.92

41 comments remix (152) share save

2,576

c/finance · Posted by u/mathfan42 1d ago

Compound Interest Visualizer

monthly = 100100

years = 3030

future value\$117,606

Gallery becomes a ranked feed: upvotes, remix counts, topic communities (c/finance). Great for discovery, calc opens in place.

InstaCalc
The free calculator library — 1,642 calcs and counting

NAVIGATION

Main page
Featured calcs
Random calc
Recent changes

CONTENTS

Finance (412)
Health & Fitness (187)
Home & DIY (143)
Cooking (96)
Travel (88)
Business (205)
Education (117)
Conversions (230)
Everyday & Fun (164)

TOOLS

Create a calc
My calcs
Cite this calc

Calc

Discussion

Edit

History (14)

Party budget calculator

From InstaCalc, the calculator anyone can edit. Maintained by [u/kazad](#); last updated 3 hours ago.

A **party budget calculator** estimates the total cost of hosting an event by combining [per-guest costs](#) with fixed expenses such as [venue rental](#) and [entertainment](#). Edit any value in the infobox — every dependent line recalculates instantly.

The model assumes cost scales linearly with attendance. For events above ~75 guests, consider the [Catering Tiers](#) remix, which introduces volume discounts. Related conventions include the [50/30/20 rule](#) for household budgeting and the [per-head metric](#) common in event planning.

See also

- Mortgage Payoff Planner
- Road Trip Fuel Cost
- Tip & Bill Splitter
- Freelance Hourly Rate
- Compound Interest Visualizer
- BMI & Calorie Target
- Recipe Scaler
- Startup Runway

Party budget — live

Party budget 🎉🍷

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerP540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + m910

perGuest = total / guest30.33

Author	kazad
Category	Everyday & Fun
Uses	18,340
Remixes	152

Every calc is a reference article: dense internal links, contents rail, live calc as the “infobox”. Authority through plainness.

InstaCalc

Search 1,642 calculators (e.g. "mortgage", "mpg", "tip")

GO

My Calcs

Help

BROWSE BY CATEGORY

Finance412

Health & Fitness187

Home & DIY143

Cooking96

Travel88

Business205

Education117

Conversions230

Everyday & Fun164

FILTER

Live editable1,204

With charts318

Forkable1,642

All calculators > Everyday & Fun > Events

Party Budget — open calc

Spec it like a part: edit values below, results update in-line. Cert: shared-link reproducible.

PARTY BUDGET, 30-GUEST, LIVE

SKU IC-18340

Party budget 🎉

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerPerson540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + music910

30.33

All calculators (showing 16 of 1,642)

PREVIEW	CALCULATOR	CATEGORY	SPEC	USES	RATING	
loan = 320,000 rate = 6.2%	Mortgage Payoff Planner See how extra payments shorten a 30-year loan.	Finance	3 in · 6 steps	24.1k	4.8 ★	Open
bill = 86.40 tip = 20%	Tip & Bill Splitter Split the check, tip included, no arguments.	Everyday & Fun	3 in · 6 steps	18.3k	4.9 ★	Open
monthly = 100 years = 30	Compound Interest Visualizer Watch \$100/month become a small fortune.	Finance	3 in · 6 steps	31.2k	4.7 ★	Open
serves = 4 → 11 flour = 2 cups	Recipe Scaler Serves 4 → serves 11, without the mental math.	Cooking	3 in · 6 steps	9.8k	4.9 ★	Open
miles = 1,240 mpg = 31	Road Trip Fuel Cost Miles, MPG, gas price → total damage.	Travel	3 in · 6 steps	7.4k	4.6 ★	Open
target = 90k/yr billable hrs	Freelance Hourly Rate Back into your rate from the income you want.	Business	3 in · 6 steps	12.6k	4.8 ★	Open
weight = 172 lb height = 5'10"	BMI & Calorie Target A gentler take on the classic formula.	Health & Fitness	3 in · 6 steps	15.9k	4.5 ★	Open
cash = 480k burn = 42k/mo	Startup Runway Cash ÷ burn = months of sleep you have left.	Business	3 in · 6 steps	8.8k	4.7 ★	Open
area = 640 ft² coats = 2	Paint Coverage Estimator Walls, coats, and how many gallons to buy.	Home & DIY	3 in · 6 steps	5.2k	4.6 ★	Open
saved = 240k save/mo = 1,500	Retirement Savings Projector When can you actually stop working?	Finance	3 in · 6 steps	22.4k	4.8 ★	Open

Ruthless density and speed: every calc is a part with specs. Filter rail, instant search, zero decoration. For power users.

InstaCalc

What
Any calculation

Category
All categories

Level
Any complexity

Create a calc

Finance

Health & Fitness

Home & DIY

Cooking

Travel

Business

Education

Conversions

Everyday & Fun

Try one right now

Every calc is live — change a number, watch everything downstream update. When it's right, share it like a link.

Start from this template

Party budget 🎉

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerPerson540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + music910

perGuest = total / guests30.33

loan = 320,000320,000

rate = 6.2%0.062

payment / mo\$1,962

Mortgage Payoff Planner

by sarah_m · Finance

Free · 24.1k uses

★ 4.8

bill = 86.4086.40

tip = 20%17.28

each (4 ppl)\$25.92

Tip & Bill Splitter

by kazad · Everyday & Fun

Free · 18.3k uses

★ 4.9

monthly = 100100

years = 3030

future value\$117,606

Compound Interest Visualizer

by mathfan42 · Finance

Free · 31.2k uses

★ 4.7

serves = 4 → 112.75x

flour = 2 cups5.5 cups

butter = 6 tbsp16.5 tbsp

Recipe Scaler

by chefdada · Cooking

Free · 9.8k uses

★ 4.9

miles = 1,2401,240

mpg = 3131

fuel cost\$156

target = 90k/yr90,000

billable hrs1,100

rate\$82/hr

weight = 172 lb78 kg

height = 5'10"1.78 m

BMI24.7

cash = 480k480,000

burn = 42k/mo42,000

runway11.4 mo

Calcs as destinations: big friendly search pill, category chips, preview-forward cards with ratings and saves.

InstaCalc

calculators for everything · everywhere · free

search calcs

go

1,642 calcs · updated 3 min ago

open calc: party budget

(edit numbers, share the url)

Party budget 🎉

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerPerson540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + music910

perGuest = total / guests30.33

FINANCE

mortgage payoff planner 24.1k

compound interest visualizer 31.2k

retirement savings projector 22.4k

loan comparison 11.1k

see all 412 →

COOKING

recipe scaler 9.8k

see all 96 →

BUSINESS

freelance hourly rate 12.6k

startup runway 8.8k

see all 205 →

TRAVEL

road trip fuel cost 7.4k

currency trip budget 5.7k

see all 88 →

HEALTH & FITNESS

bmi & calorie target 15.9k

workout pace calculator 6.3k

see all 187 →

HOME & DIY

paint coverage estimator 5.2k

solar panel roi 4.9k

see all 143 →

CONVERSIONS

unit converter pro 40.7k

see all 230 →

EDUCATION

gpa calculator 13.7k

see all 117 →

EVERYDAY & FUN

tip & bill splitter 18.3k

see all 164 →

© instacalc — help · safety · privacy · feedback · make a calc

Zero design as a feature: the entire gallery on one page as plain links. Fastest possible scan; nothing competes with the content.

InstaCalc new | top | show | gallery | submit calc login

1. ▲ Show iC: Party Budget — a live calc, editable right here (instacalc.com/party-budget)
417 points by kazad 3h ago | flag | hide | 212 comments | remix

```
# Party budget 🎉  
guests = 30 30  
costPerPerson = 18 18  
food = guests * costPerPerson 540  
venue = 250 250  
music = 120 120  
total = food + venue + music 910  
perGuest = total / guests 30.33
```

2. ▲ Mortgage Payoff Planner (instacalc.com/mortgage)
341 points by sarah_m 2d ago | flag | hide | 84 comments | remix

3. ▲ Tip & Bill Splitter (instacalc.com/tipsplit)
324 points by kazad 5h ago | flag | hide | 41 comments | remix

4. ▲ Compound Interest Visualizer (instacalc.com/compound)
307 points by mathfan42 1d ago | flag | hide | 129 comments | remix

5. ▲ Recipe Scaler (instacalc.com/recipe)
290 points by chefdata 3d ago | flag | hide | 22 comments | remix

6. ▲ Road Trip Fuel Cost (instacalc.com/roadtrip)
273 points by nomadic 6d ago | flag | hide | 17 comments | remix

7. ▲ Freelance Hourly Rate (instacalc.com/freelance)
256 points by indiehacker 12h ago | flag | hide | 96 comments | remix

8. ▲ BMI & Calorie Target (instacalc.com/bmi)
239 points by fitcoach 1d ago | flag | hide | 63 comments | remix

9. ▲ Startup Runway (instacalc.com/runway)
222 points by foundr 4d ago | flag | hide | 54 comments | remix

10. ▲ Paint Coverage Estimator (instacalc.com/paint)
205 points by diyanne 1w ago | flag | hide | 12 comments | remix

11. ▲ Retirement Savings Projector (instacalc.com/retire)
188 points by futureme 8h ago | flag | hide | 201 comments | remix

12. ▲ Unit Converter Pro (instacalc.com/unitpro)
171 points by kazad 3h ago | flag | hide | 310 comments | remix

13. ▲ Loan Comparison (instacalc.com/loancmp)
154 points by sarah_m 2d ago | flag | hide | 45 comments | remix

14. ▲ Workout Pace Calculator (instacalc.com/pace)
137 points by runnerd 5d ago | flag | hide | 19 comments | remix

15. ▲ Solar Panel ROI (instacalc.com/solar)
120 points by greenwatt 1w ago | flag | hide | 31 comments | remix

16. ▲ GPA Calculator (instacalc.com/gpa)
103 points by profplum 1d ago | flag | hide | 58 comments | remix

Pure ranked list with points and comments. The first item expands inline — using a calc never leaves the list.

InstaCalc

Deliver to
Everyone, free

All categories

Search calculators

⌵

Today's Featured

Finance

Health

Conversions

New Releases

Editor's Picks

Hello, kalid

My Calcs & Lists

Returns & Remixes

⌵

All

Today's Featured

Finance

Health

Conversions

New Releases

Editor's Picks

⚡ Keep working: Party Budget (opened 5 min ago)

guests = 30

costPerPerson = 18

total = guests * costPerPerson + 370

perGuest = total / quests

30

18

910

30.33

Category

☐ Finance

☐ Health & Fitness

☐ Home & DIY

☐ Cooking

☐ Travel

☐ Business

Avg. rating

★★★★ & up

★★★ & up

Complexity

☐ Quick (≤5 lines)

☐ Standard

☐ Deep model

1–6 of over 1,600 results for "calculators"

loan = 320,000

320,000

rate = 6.2%

0.062

payment / mo

\$1,962

Mortgage Payoff Planner

★★★★☆ 2,268

24.1k+ used this month · by sarah_m

- See how extra payments shorten a 30-year loan.
- Live editing — results update as you type
- Share as a link, remix with one click

bill = 86.40

86.40

tip = 20%

17.28

each (4 ppl)

\$25.92

Tip & Bill Splitter

★★★★☆ 1,107

18.3k+ used this month · by kazad

- Split the check, tip included, no arguments.
- Live editing — results update as you type
- Share as a link, remix with one click

monthly = 100

100

years = 30

30

future value

\$117,606

Compound Interest Visualizer

★★★★☆ 3,483

31.2k+ used this month · by mathfan42

- Watch \$100/month become a small fortune.
- Live editing — results update as you type
- Share as a link, remix with one click

Recipe Scaler

★★★★☆ 594

9.8k+ used this month · by chefdata

- Watch \$100/month become a small fortune.
- Live editing — results update as you type
- Share as a link, remix with one click

Free

Instant — runs in your browser

Ships from: instacalc.com

Use now

Save to My Calcs

Free

Instant — runs in your browser

Ships from: instacalc.com

Use now

Save to My Calcs

Free

Instant — runs in your browser

Ships from: instacalc.com

Use now

Save to My Calcs

Free

Instant — runs in your browser

Ships from: instacalc.com

Use now

Save to My Calcs

Search-dominant with facet filters and heavy trust signals: ratings, usage counts, “used this month”. Calc gets a Buy-Box.

InstaCalc

Search calcs

+ Create

Home

Quick calcs

Subscriptions

My calcs

History

Saved

AUTHORS YOU FOLLOW

sarah_m

kazad

mathfan42

► Party Budget LIVE - EDIT ANYTHING

Party budget 🎉

guests = 30 30

costPerPerson = 18 18

food = guests * costPerPerson 540

venue = 250 250

music = 120 120

total = food + venue + music 910

perGuest = total / guests 30.33

Up next

loa... 320,000

rate ... 0.062

paym... \$1,962

bill ... 86.40

tip ... 17.28

each... \$25.92

monthly... 100

years = ... 30

fu... \$117,606

serve... 2.75x

fl... 5.5 cups

b... 16.5 tbsp

Mortgage Payoff Planner

sarah_m · 24.1k uses

Tip & Bill Splitter

kazad · 18.3k uses

Compound Interest Visualizer

mathfan42 · 31.2k uses

Recipe Scaler

chefdata · 9.8k uses

All

Finance

Health & Fitness

Home & DIY

Cooking

Travel

Business

Education

Conversions

Everyday & Fun

miles = 1,240 1,240

mpg = 31 31

fuel cost \$156

6 steps

N Road Trip Fuel Cost

nomadic · 7.4k uses · 6d ago

target = 90k/yr 90,000

billable hrs 1,100

rate \$82/hr

6 steps

I Freelance Hourly Rate

indiehackr · 12.6k uses · 12h ago

weight = 172 lb 78 kg

height = 5'10" 1.78 m

BMI 24.7

6 steps

F BMI & Calorie Target

fitcoach · 15.9k uses · 1d ago

cash = 480k 480,000

burn = 42k/mo 42,000

runway 11.4 mo

6 steps

F Startup Runway

foundr · 8.8k uses · 4d ago

area = 640 ft² 640

coats = 2 2

gallons 3.6

6 steps

D Paint Coverage Estimator

diyanne · 5.2k uses · 1w ago

saved = 240k 240,000

save/mo = 1,500 1,500

at 65 \$1.9M

6 steps

F Retirement Savings Projector

futureme · 22.4k uses · 8h ago

Calcs as videos: preview thumbnails with a “6 steps” badge, author channels, chips for topics. Subscriptions = follow calc authors.

InstaCalc

Home

Search

Your Library

YOUR COLLECTIONS

Wedding planning

House hunt

Marathon prep

Freelance ops

+ New collection

Good afternoon

Mortgage Payoff Planner

Tip & Bill Splitter

Compound Interest Visualizer

Recipe Scaler

Road Trip Fuel Cost

Freelance Hourly Rate

Made for you

loan = 3... 320...

rate = 6... 0.0...

payment ... \$1,...

Mortgage Payoff Pla...

sarah_m · 24.1k uses

bill = 86... 86....

tip = 20% 17.28

each (4 ... \$25...

Tip & Bill Splitter

kazad · 18.3k uses

monthly = 1... 1...

years = 30 30

future ... \$117...

Compound Interest ...

mathfan42 · 31.2k uses

serves = 4... 2....

flour = ... 5.5 ...

butter =... 16.5...

Recipe Scaler

chefdata · 9.8k uses

miles = 1... 1,2...

mpg = 31 31

fuel cost \$156

Road Trip Fuel Cost

nomadic · 7.4k uses

Trending calculators

target = ... 90,...

billable ... 1,1...

rate \$82/hr

Freelance Hourly Rate

indiehacker · 12.6k uses

weight = 1... 78...

height = ... 1.7...

BMI 24.7

BMI & Calorie Target

fitcoach · 15.9k uses

cash = ... 480,...

burn = 42... 42,...

runway 11.4 mo

Startup Runway

foundr · 8.8k uses

area = 640 ... 6...

coats = 2 2

gallons 3.6

Paint Coverage Esti...

diyanne · 5.2k uses

saved = ... 240,...

save/mo = ... 1,...

at 65 \$1.9M

Retirement Savings ...

futureme · 22.4k uses

Party Budget

kazad · total: \$910 · per
guest: \$30.33

guests = 30

total = guests*18 +

30
910

Library with horizontal shelves (“Made for you”, “Trending”) and playlists as calc collections. The open calc lives in a persistent now-playing bar.

InstaCalc

Search

Updates

Settings

MY CALCS

Party Budget

Catering remix

Mortgage vs Rent

Japan trip

SHARED

Team budget Q3

Sprint velocity

EXPLORE

Gallery

Templates

Trash

Party Budget / My calcs

Share

Party Budget

Every line is a block. Type `/` for formulas, tables, and charts — results update live as you edit.

Party budget

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerPerson540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + music910

perGuest = total / guests30.33

+ Add a line

Gallery

All calcsBy usesRecent

Filter · Sort

Name	Category	Author	Uses	Edited
Mortgage Payoff Planner	Finance	sarah_m	24.1k	2d ago
Tip & Bill Splitter	Everyday & Fun	kazad	18.3k	5h ago
Compound Interest Visualizer	Finance	mathfan42	31.2k	1d ago
Recipe Scaler	Cooking	chefdata	9.8k	3d ago
Road Trip Fuel Cost	Travel	nomadic	7.4k	6d ago
Freelance Hourly Rate	Business	indiehacker	12.6k	12h ago
BMI & Calorie Target	Health & Fitness	fitcoach	15.9k	1d ago

Calcs as pages in a personal workspace: sidebar tree, breadcrumbs, blocks. Gallery is a linked database at the bottom of the page.

The screenshot displays the InstaCalc application interface, which is organized into three main sections: a sidebar, a central list, and a right-hand detail panel.

Sidebar (Left): Contains navigation options under the 'InstaCalc' header. It includes 'Inbox', 'My calcs', 'Gallery', and 'Starred'. Below these are 'VIEWS' (Trending, New this week, From people I follow) and 'COLLECTIONS' (Events, House hunt, Consulting).

Central List: A list of calculators, each with a status indicator (green or blue dot), a title, a category tag, and a time indicator. The calculators listed are: Mortgage Payoff Planner, Tip & Bill Splitter, Compound Interest Visualizer, Recipe Scaler, Road Trip Fuel Cost, Freelance Hourly Rate, BMI & Calorie Target, Startup Runway, Paint Coverage Estimator, Retirement Savings Projector, Unit Converter Pro, Loan Comparison, Workout Pace Calculator, Solar Panel ROI, GPA Calculator, and Currency Trip Budget.

Command Palette (Center): A modal window is open over the 'Tip & Bill Splitter' calculator. It features a search bar with the text '⌘K — Type a command or search calcs...' and a list of actions: 'New calc', 'Browse gallery', '"mortgage" — 12 calcs', and 'Share current calc'.

Right Panel (Party Budget Detail): Displays the details for the 'Party Budget' calculator (CALC-141). It shows the title, a 'Party Budget' icon, and a list of variables and their values: guests = 30, costPerPerson = 18, food = 540, venue = 250, music = 120, total = 910, and perGuest = 30.33. Below this, it shows the status (Live), owner (kazad), collection (Events), uses (18,340), and shared (public link).

For heavy users: dense triage list, side peek, and a ⌘K palette as the primary navigation. Everything reachable without the mouse.

InstaCalc

Type / to search calcs...

7

Gallery

Trending

My Calcs

+ ▼

👤

kazad / party-budget

Public

👁 Watch 41

🔗 Remix 312

★ Star 2.4k

📄 Calc

📄 README

💬 Questions 12

🔗 Remixes 312

🕒 History 14

📊 Insights

party-budget.calc

8 lines · live

Raw · Blame · 🍴

```
1 # Party budget 🎉
2 guests = 30 30
3 costPerPerson = 18 18
4 food = guests * costPerPerson 540
5 venue = 250 250
6 music = 120 120
7 total = food + venue + music 910
8 perGuest = total / guests 30.33
```

Party Budget

Estimate event costs from a per-guest rate plus fixed expenses. Change `guests` and watch `total` and `perGuest` recalculate.

Remixing: hit `Remix` to get your own editable copy with attribution back to this calc.

About

The party-planning math everyone redoes from scratch, done once, shared forever.

`events` `budgeting` `everyday`
`beginner-friendly`

☆ 2,412 stars
🔗 312 remixes
▶ 18.3k uses
👁 41 watching

Remixes

🔗 kazad/tipsplit-remix · 5h ago
🔗 mathfan42/compound-remix · 1d ago
🔗 chefdada/recipe-remix · 3d ago
🔗 nomadic/roadtrip-remix · 6d ago

Contributors

👤 📄 🍴 🕒 +9

A calc is a repo: stars, forks (“remixes”), history, README. Naturally social + versioned — remix culture made explicit.

[InstaCalc](#) [Gallery](#) [Templates](#) [Docs](#) [Pricing](#) [Sign in](#) [Start now >](#)

Calculation infrastructure for everyday life

Millions of decisions come down to a little math. Build a live, shareable calculator in seconds — no spreadsheet, no signup, no formulas hidden in cells.

[Start calculating](#)

```
# Party budget 🎉
guests = 30
costPerPerson = 18
food = guests * costPerPerson
venue = 250
music = 120
total = food + venue + music
perGuest = total / guests
```

30
18
540
250
120
910
30.33

TRUSTED FOR THE MATH BEHIND

[WEDDINGS](#) [STARTUPS](#) [ROAD TRIPS](#) [CLASSROOMS](#) [RENOVATIONS](#)



Live by default

Every value is editable, every result reactive. Readers don't just see your math — they can push on it.

[Try the editor >](#)



Share like a link

The whole calc lives in the URL. Send it, embed it, fork it — versioned and attributed automatically.

[See sharing >](#)



A gallery of 1,600+

Mortgages, marathons, recipes, runway. Start from working math instead of a blank page.

[Browse gallery >](#)

A real marketing homepage: hero with a floating live product demo, social proof, feature triplet. For the logged-out first impression.

InstaCalcParty Budget.icalcAutoSave ✓

Search (Alt+Q)Sharekalid

FileHomeInsertFormulasDataGalleryShare

PasteCut

BBold%Percent\$Currency.00Decimals

ΣAutoSumfxFunctionChart

Browse GalleryShare LinkRemix

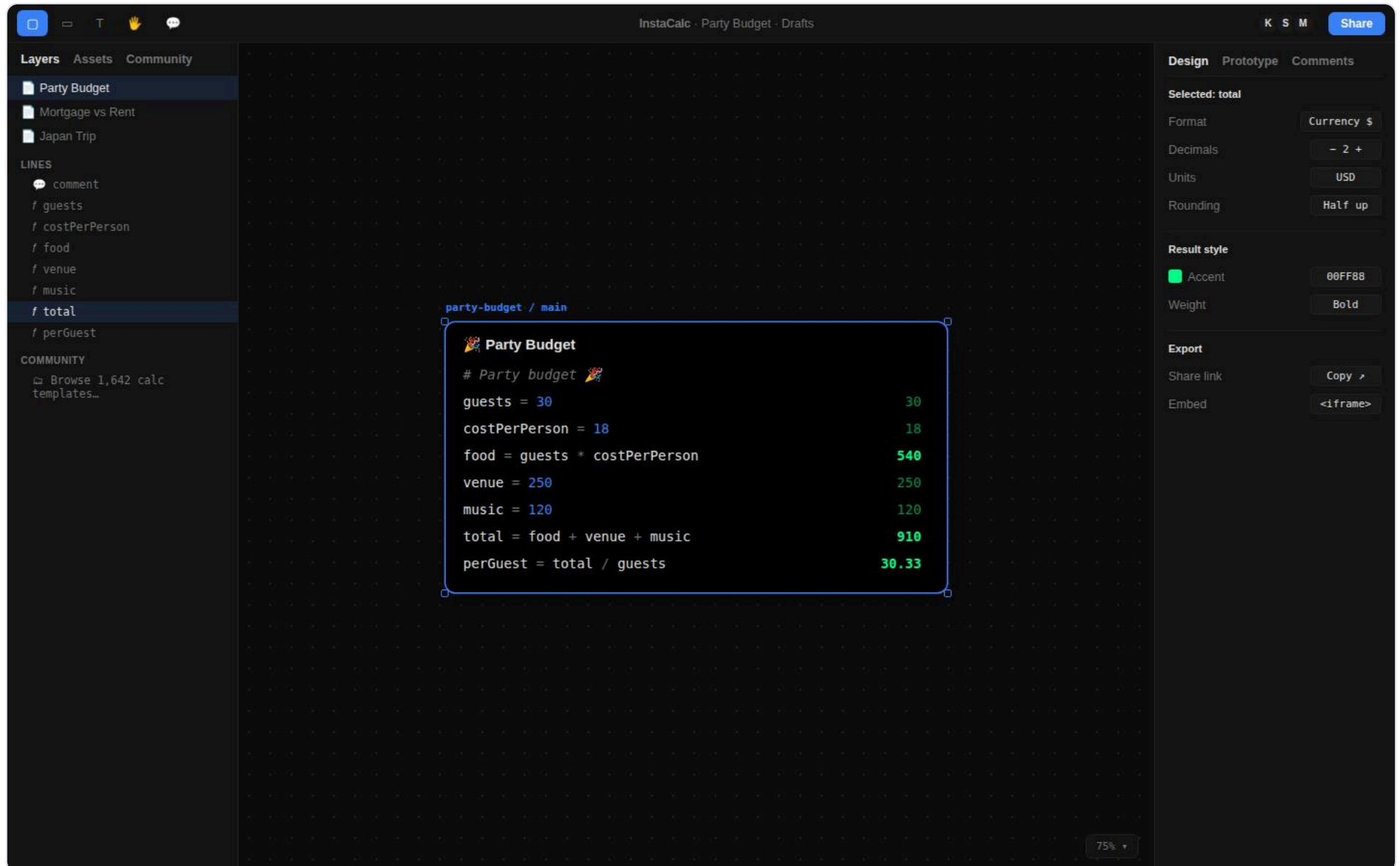
B7fxtotal = food + venue + music

	A — label	B — formula (editable)	C — result
1	note	# Party budget 🎉	
2	guests	guests = 30	30
3	costPerPerson	costPerPerson = 18	18
4	food	food = guests * costPerPerson	540
5	venue	venue = 250	250
6	music	music = 120	120
7	total	total = food + venue + music	910
8	perGuest	perGuest = total / guests	30.33

Party BudgetMortgageTrip Plan+

ReadySum: 1,898.33 · Count: 7Live recalculation: ON100%

Meets spreadsheet users where they live: ribbon, formula bar, editable cells with row/column headers, sheet tabs as multiple calcs.



Calc as an object on an infinite canvas: layers panel lists every line, properties panel controls format/units/decimals. Community tab = gallery.

The screenshot displays the InstaCalc website interface, which features a grid of various calculators. The top navigation bar includes links for Home, Explore, and Create, along with a search bar and user icons. The calculators are arranged in a grid, each with a title, a brief description, and a visual representation of its output. The calculators include:

- Party Budget**: A calculator for party planning, showing inputs like guests, cost per person, food, venue, music, and total. It is highlighted with a green border.
- Compound Interest Visualizer**: A calculator for visualizing compound interest, showing inputs like monthly amount, years, and output like total amount.
- BMI & Calorie Target**: A calculator for BMI and calorie target, showing inputs like weight, height, and BMI, and output like calorie target.
- Unit Converter Pro**: A calculator for unit conversion, showing inputs like 16 km and output like 22.2°C.
- GPA Calculator**: A calculator for GPA, showing inputs like credits and points, and output like GPA.
- Party Budget**: A calculator for party planning, showing inputs like loan, rate, and payment, and output like total payment.
- Recipe Scaler**: A calculator for scaling recipes, showing inputs like serves, flour, and butter, and output like scaled amounts.
- Startup Runway**: A calculator for startup runway, showing inputs like cash and output like runway in months.
- Loan Comparison**: A calculator for comparing loans, showing inputs like 15yr and 30yr, and output like total payment.
- Currency Trip Budget**: A calculator for trip budget, showing inputs like budget, days, and total, and output like total cost.
- Mortgage Payoff Planner**: A calculator for mortgage payoff, showing inputs like bill and output like payoff amount.
- Road Trip Fuel Cost**: A calculator for road trip fuel cost, showing inputs like miles and output like fuel cost.
- Paint Coverage Estimator**: A calculator for paint coverage, showing inputs like area and coats, and output like paint coverage.
- Workout Pace Calculator**: A calculator for workout pace, showing inputs like 10k goal and output like pace.
- Tip & Bill Splitter**: A calculator for tip and bill splitting, showing inputs like bill and output like total tip.
- Freelance Hourly Rate**: A calculator for freelance hourly rate, showing inputs like target and billable hours, and output like hourly rate.
- Retirement Savings Projector**: A calculator for retirement savings, showing inputs like saved, save/mo, and at, and output like total savings.
- Solar Panel ROI**: A calculator for solar panel ROI, showing inputs like install and output like ROI.

Pure visual browse: masonry of calc “pins” at mixed sizes — some show working, some just the big answer. Save to boards = collections.

[InstaCalc](#) [Gallery](#) [Create](#) [Templates](#) [Learn](#) [Support](#)

InstaCalc

Math, beautifully **shared**.

Type it. See it. Send it. The calculator that shows its work.

[Try it free >](#) [Browse the gallery >](#)

Party Budget

Party budget

guests =	30
costPerPerson =	18
food = guests * costPerPerson	540
venue =	250
music =	120
total = food + venue + music	910
perGuest = total / guests	30.33

Gallery. 1,642 calcs strong.

Start from working math — remix anything.

Radical focus: huge type, one device frame, generous whitespace. The gallery appears only as a teaser band. Sells the feeling, not the features.

The screenshot displays the InstaCalc Clubhouse interface. On the left is a sidebar with the InstaCalc HQ logo, navigation options like Threads, All DMs, and Gallery, a list of channels (including #finance, #health, #home, #cooking, #travel, #business, #education, and an option to add channels), and direct messages with sarah_m, mathfan42, and chefdata.

The main area shows the #finance channel, which has 2,341 members and a description: "Money math: mortgages, loans, FIRE, and 'can I afford this?'".

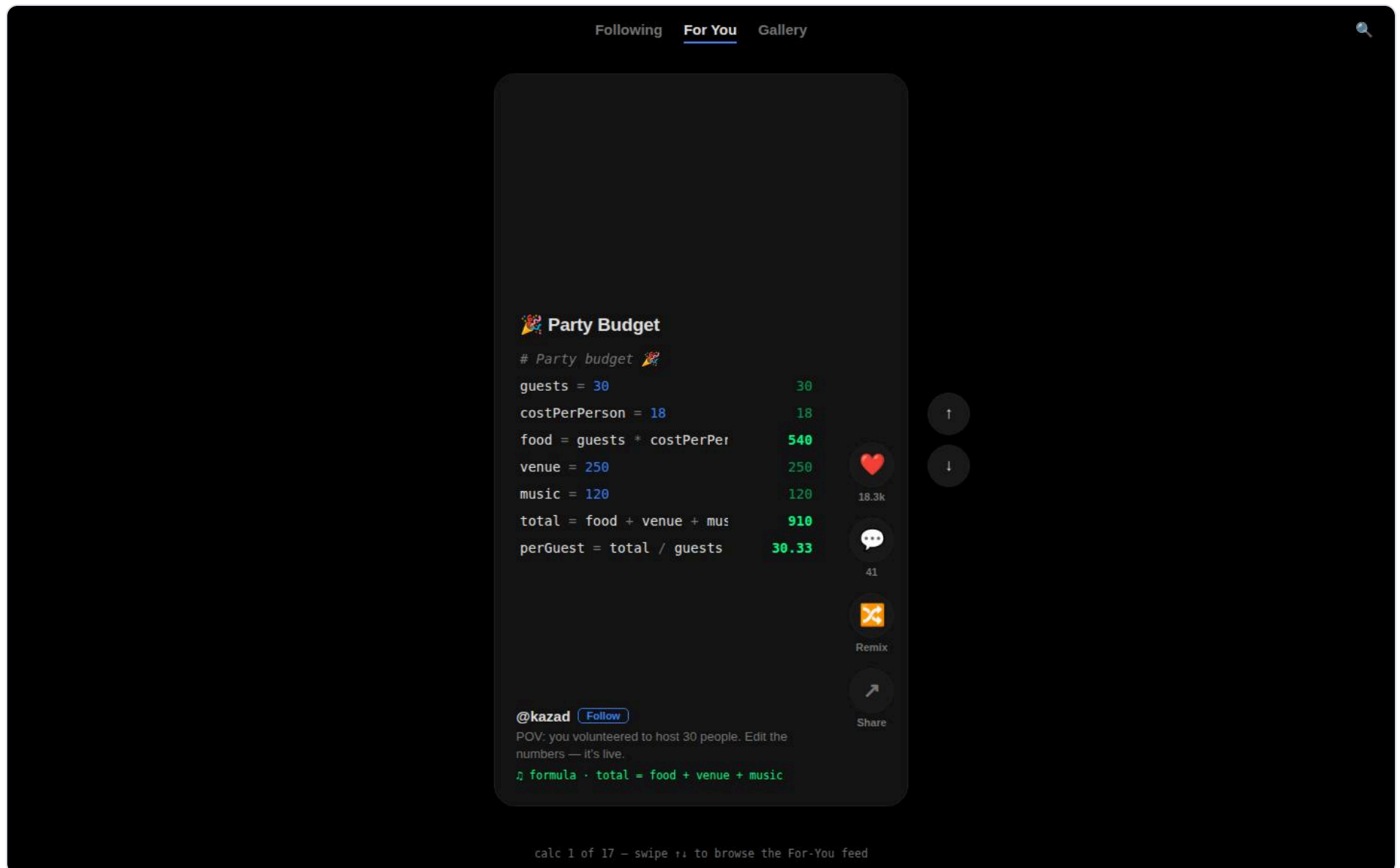
Two messages are visible:

- A message from sarah_m at 10:42 AM: "Rebuilt the mortgage payoff calc so extra payments are a single variable — try dragging it 📌". Below the text is a live card for the "Mortgage Payoff Planner" from instacalc.com/mortgage, showing a live calc with 24.1k uses. The card displays: loan = 320,000 (320,000), rate = 6.2% (0.062), and payment / mo (\$1,962). It has 12 reactions (👍, 🔥, 🌟, etc.).
- A message from kazad at 10:51 AM: "Love it. Same trick works for event budgets — this one's live, edit right here in the channel:". Below the text is a live card for the "Party Budget" from instacalc.com/party-budget, showing a live calc with anyone able to edit the preview. The card displays: # Party budget 🎉, guests = 30 (30), costPerPerson = 18 (18), food = guests * costPerPerson (540), venue = 250 (250), music = 120 (120), and total = food + venue + music (910). It has 9 reactions (👍, 🔥, 🌟, etc.).

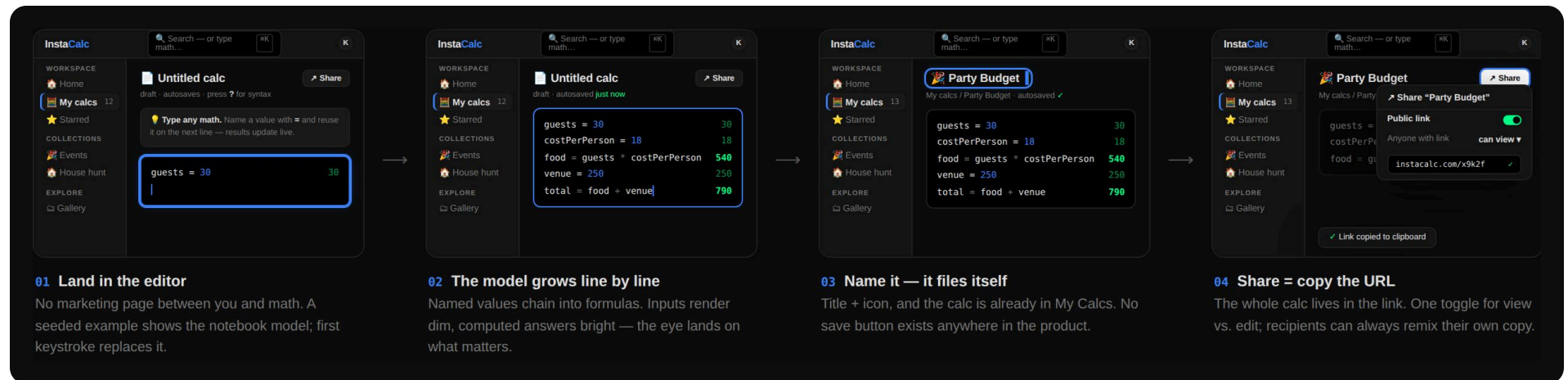
A third message from mathfan42 at 11:02 AM says: "remixed it for potlucks → #fun. Reply in thread with your per-guest numbers 📌 14 replies".

At the bottom is a message input field: "Message #finance — paste a calc link to unfurl it live..." with a + icon and a text color picker (Aa).

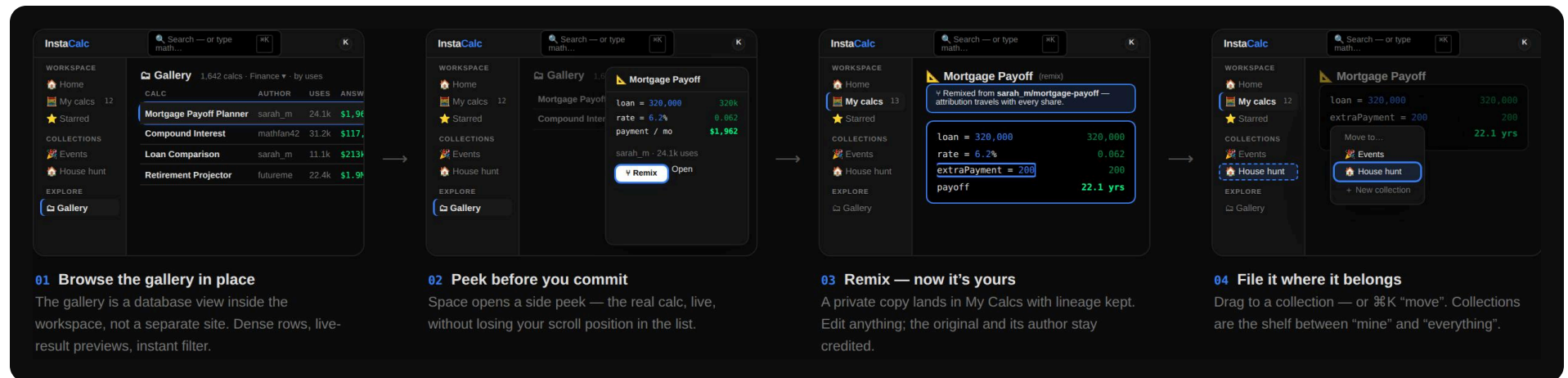
Community-first: topic channels, calcs shared as unfurled live cards inside conversation, reactions as lightweight ratings.



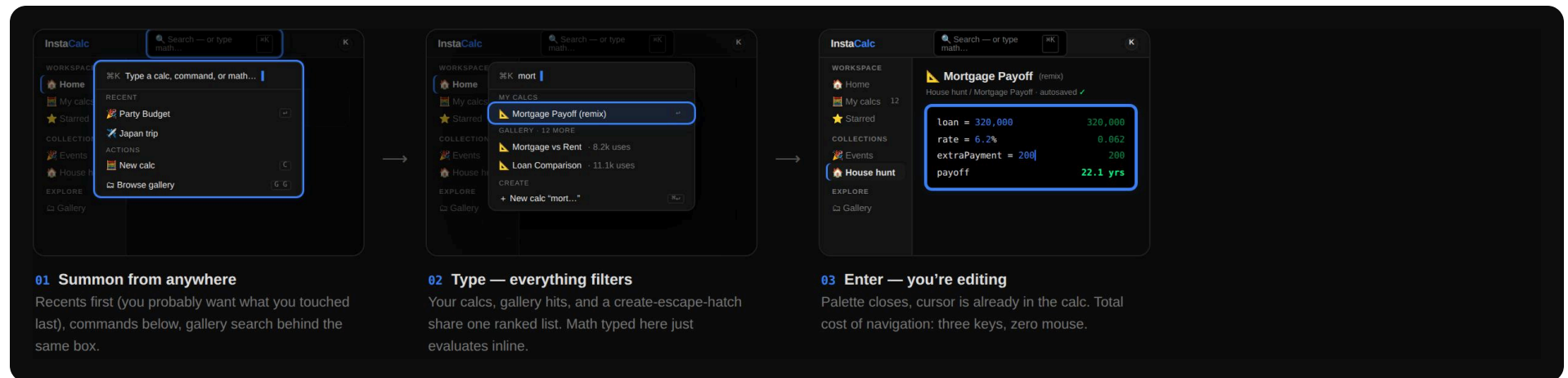
Full-screen, one calc at a time, swipe to browse. Remix/like/share as first-class gestures. Gallery becomes a For-You feed of math.



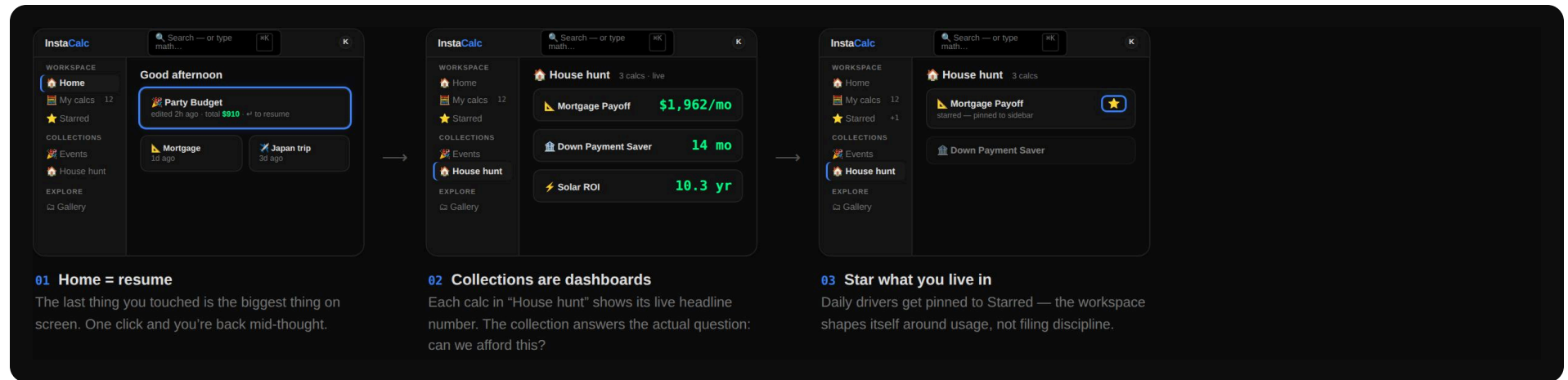
The front door is the editor itself — no landing page, no sign-up wall. A new visitor is calculating within five seconds and holding a shareable link within sixty. No save button exists anywhere in the product.



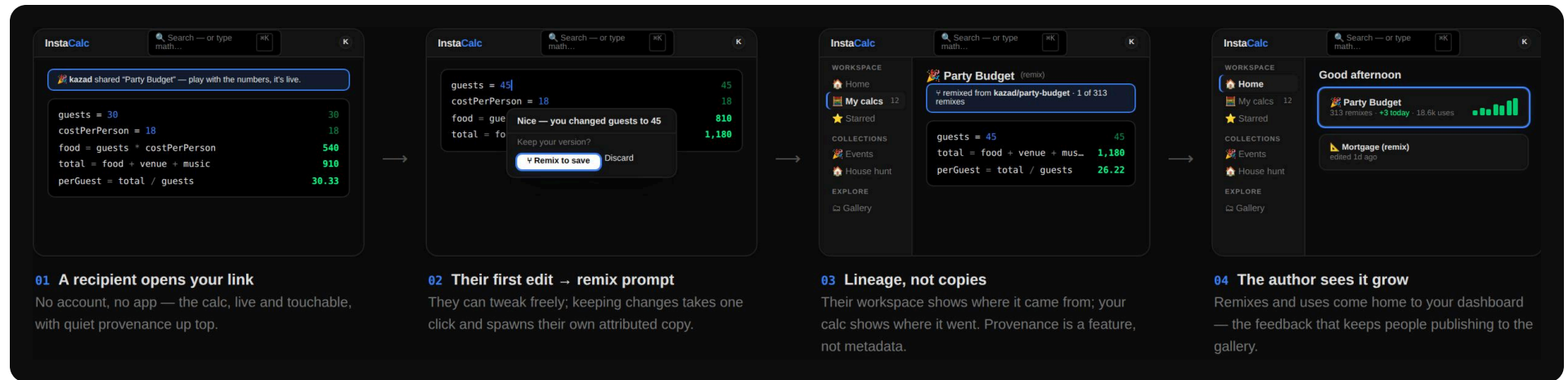
Browsing is never a dead end. Anything in the gallery can be peeked without leaving the list, then remixed into your workspace with attribution kept — find → own in four clicks.



One shortcut reaches everything ⌘+⌘+K your calcs, the whole gallery, every command. Heavy users never touch the sidebar; it exists for the days you're browsing, not the days you know where you're going.



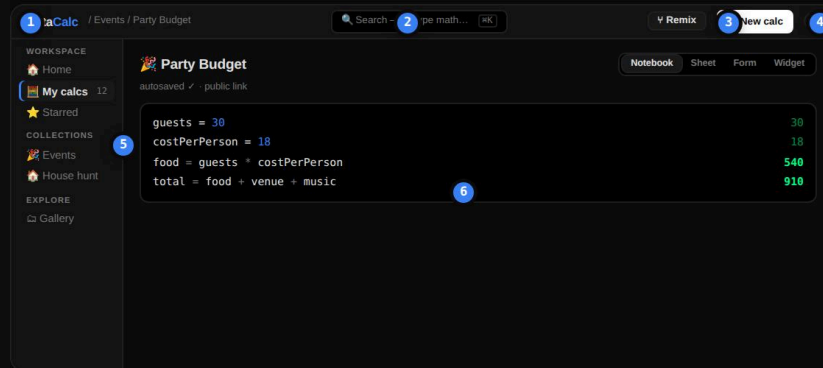
Return visits open on your work, not a feed. Collections aren't folders and **every calc surfaces its live headline answer**, so a collection reads as a dashboard: "House hunt" answers "can we afford this?" at a glance.



Sharing isn't an export &  it's how the gallery grows. A shared link is live for the recipient, editing prompts a remix, and every remix feeds attribution (and pride) back to the author.

SYS 01 Anatomy of the global frame

Every screen in the product is this frame. Nothing else is ever global — no second toolbar, no floating menus. If a control isn't one of these six, it lives inside the stage.

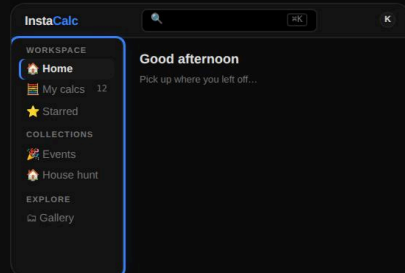


- 1 Brand = Home.** Always returns to your workspace. No separate "home" tab.
- 2 The omnibox.** Search, commands, or raw math — $\mathbb{K}$ from anywhere. It's the whole nav for keyboard people.
- 3 Create, always.** Remix (make this mine) and New calc ($\mathbb{C}$) never leave the frame — creation is one action away on every screen.
- 4 You.** Account, theme, settings. The only menu in the product.
- 5 The contextual rail.** Same slot, different tool — workspace tree at home, calc outline while editing, filters in the gallery. (SYS 02.)
- 6 The stage.** Exactly one primary object — a calc, a collection, or the gallery. Never two things competing for the same screen.

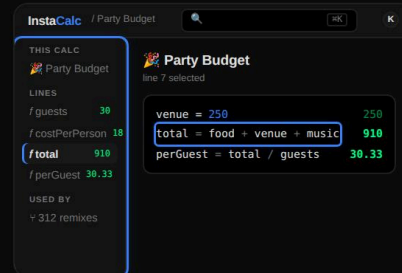
Every screen in the product is this frame — brand=home, the $\mathbb{K}$ omnibox, create always one action away, the contextual rail, and a stage that holds exactly one primary object. Nothing else is ever global.

SYS 02 One rail, three contexts

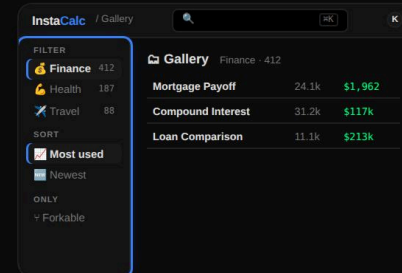
The left rail is a slot, not a fixed menu. It always answers the same question — “what’s around the thing I’m looking at?” — so its contents follow the stage.

**A At home: your stuff**

Workspace tree — calcs, collections, gallery door. The filing cabinet.

**B In a calc: the outline**

Every line with its live value — click to jump, exactly like a doc’s table of contents. Big models stay navigable.

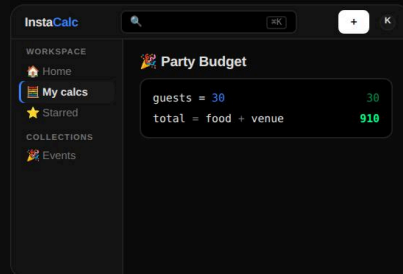
**C In the gallery: filters**

Categories, sort, facets — McMaster density where it belongs, invisible everywhere else.

The left rail is a slot, not a fixed menu. It always answers “what’s around the thing I’m looking at?” — workspace tree at home, a live-value outline inside a calc, filters in the gallery.

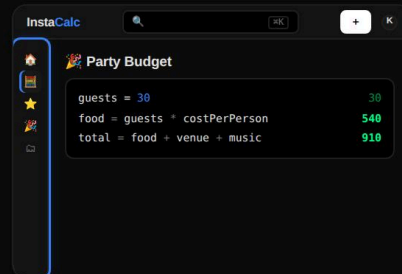
SYS 03 The focus dial

Navigation earns its keep when you're lost, and gets out of the way when you're working. [F] cycles the frame through three densities — the calc never moves or reflows, chrome just falls away around it.



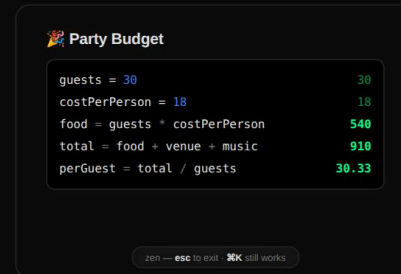
1 Expanded — browsing days

Full rail with labels. For orienting, filing, exploring.



2 Icons — working days

Rail collapses to a strip; hover peeks labels. The default once a calc is open.



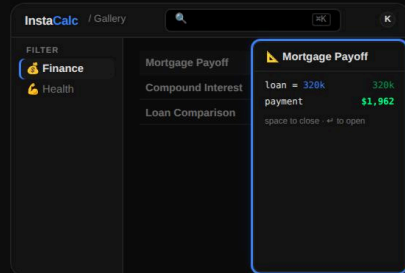
3 Zen — presenting & embedding

No chrome at all. This is also exactly what a shared link or iframe shows — the share view IS zen mode.

The [F] key cycles the frame through three densities — expanded rail for browsing days, icon strip for working days, and zen for presenting. Zen doubles as exactly what a shared link or iframe shows.

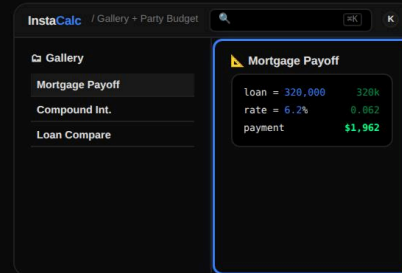
SYS 04 Opening a calc from anywhere

Browsing and using sit on an **escalation ladder** — glance, compare, commit — so choosing to look at something never costs you the place you were standing.



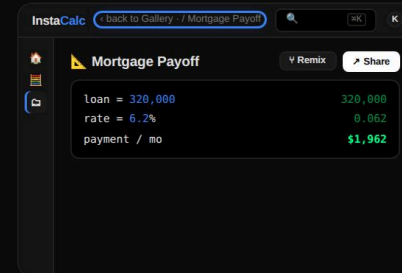
1 Peek — glance

space on any row. Live preview, list keeps your scroll. Cost of curiosity: zero.



2 Split — compare

Drag the peek open into a split: browse on the left, a fully editable calc on the right. How you shop for a starting point.



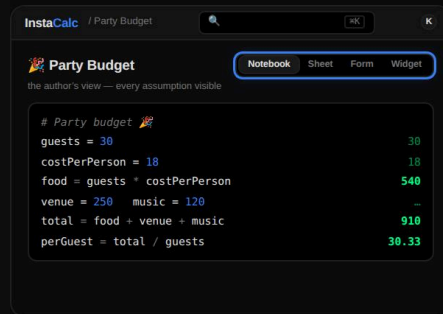
3 Full — commit

promotes to the full stage; breadcrumb remembers the way back. Browser back always works — every state is a URL.

An escalation ladder: peek (space — live preview, keeps your scroll), split (browse and edit side by side), full (breadcrumb remembers the way back). Curiosity never costs you your place.

SYS 05 View modes — one model, four lenses

The calc is the data; the view is a lens picked **per audience**. Authors live in Notebook, spreadsheet folks get Sheet, recipients who shouldn't see formulas get Form, and the internet gets a Widget. Same URL, same live engine — only the lens changes.



InstaCalc / Party Budget

Party Budget

the author's view — every assumption visible

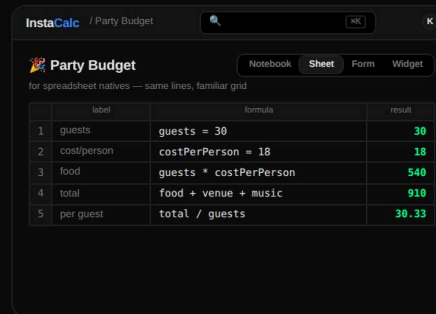
Notebook Sheet Form Widget

```
# Party budget
guests = 30
costPerPerson = 18
food = guests * costPerPerson
venue = 250 music = 120
total = food + venue + music
perGuest = total / guests
```

guests =	30
costPerPerson =	18
food =	540
venue =	250
music =	120
total =	910
perGuest =	30.33

N Notebook — for authors

The default. Reasoning reads top to bottom; the math IS the document.



InstaCalc / Party Budget

Party Budget

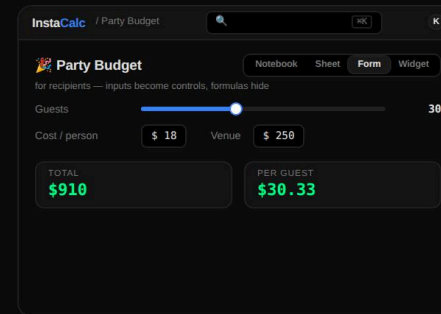
for spreadsheet natives — same lines, familiar grid

Notebook Sheet Form Widget

	label	formula	result
1	guests	guests = 30	30
2	cost/person	costPerPerson = 18	18
3	food	guests * costPerPerson	540
4	total	food + venue + music	910
5	per guest	total / guests	30.33

S Sheet — for spreadsheet refugees

Rows, columns, a formula bar. Excel muscle memory, InstaCalc engine.



InstaCalc / Party Budget

Party Budget

for recipients — inputs become controls, formulas hide

Notebook Sheet Form Widget

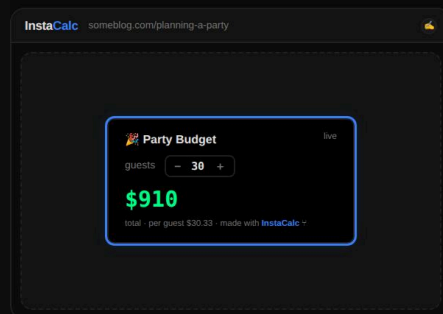
Guests

Cost / person Venue

TOTAL **\$910** PER GUEST **\$30.33**

F Form — for the person you sent it to

Author marks lines as inputs; everything else becomes headline answers. Zero syntax exposure.



InstaCalc someblog.com/planning-a-party

Party Budget

live

guests

\$910

total per guest \$30.33 made with InstaCalc

W Widget — for everywhere else

An iframe that stays live. One input, one number, attribution link — every embed is a door back to the gallery.

Same calc, same engine, four faces: Notebook for authors, Sheet for spreadsheet natives, Form for recipients (inputs become controls, formulas hide), Widget for embeds — every one live.

SYS 06 The URL is the state

No hidden app state: identity, your edits, and the lens all live in the address bar. Copying the URL **always** reproduces exactly what you're looking at — which is why Share is just “copy”.

instacalc.com/`kazad/party-budget` `#` `guests=45` `&` `view=form`

Identity

Author + calc name. Stable forever; remixes get their own.

Your state

Values you changed, in the hash — private until you share the link, never hitting a server.

The lens

notebook · sheet · form · widget — the same calc, dressed for its audience.

Identity + your edits + the lens, all in the address bar. Copying the URL always reproduces exactly what you see — which is why Share is just “copy”.

+
bonus

Light theme, same bones

every layout inherits the site's light tokens — toggle with T or the  button

instacalc.com/evolve?l=reddit&theme=light

InstaCalc

Search calculators, topics, people...

Browse Gallery

+ Create Calc

FEEDS

Home

Popular

All

TOPICS

c/finance

c/health

c/home

c/cooking

c/travel

c/business

c/education

c/conversions

c/fun

Your draft · autosaved · share when ready

Party Budget

Party budget 🎉

guests = 3030

costPerPerson = 1818

food = guests * costPerPerson540

venue = 250250

music = 120120

total = food + venue + music910

perGuest = total / guests30.33

About InstaCalc

The calculator that shows its work. Build a calc in seconds, share it like a link, remix anyone's math.

Create Calc

Browse Gallery

Trending today

BMI & Calorie Target

Startup Runway

Paint Coverage Estimator

Retirement Savings Projector

3,400

c/finance · Posted by u/sarah_m 2d ago

Mortgage Payoff Planner

loan = 320,000320,000

rate = 6.2%0.062

payment / mo\$1,962

84 comments remix (311) share save

2,988

c/fun · Posted by u/kazad 5h ago

Tip & Bill Splitter

bill = 86.4086.40

tip = 20%17.28

each (4 ppl)\$25.92

41 comments remix (152) share save

2,576

c/finance · Posted by u/mathfan42 1d ago

Compound Interest Visualizer

monthly = 100100

years = 3030

future value\$117,606

The whole gallery is built on the jshell CSS variables (`assets/tool.css`), so the existing light/dark setting (`localStorage jshell_theme`) restyles all 20 layouts for free.